

# Digital Forensics & Incident Response Report

Case: **Vanko**

Generated: 2026-06-15 20:02:01 UTC | Tool: Find Evil! autonomous DFIR agent | AI-assisted, independently judge-verified

## Executive Summary

Overall intent classification: **MALICE**

Insider data theft by Anthony Vanko ('PC User') on host StarkSurface. Using his own valid account, on 2016-06-29 he mapped the corporate research file server \\192.168.1.5\StarkResearch as drive Z: and browsed directly into the 'Level 7/8 Classified', 'Biochemical' and 'Mutant Genome' directories, opening classified documents (ZF DNA splice test notes.docx, Rapid cell regeneration research.docx, Nina Lam mutation research). He installed 7-Zip and VeraCrypt from Downloads, then on 2016-06-30 archived the stolen material into a deceptively named 'vacation photos.7z' (plus NinaResearch.zip) and staged it on a removable D: drive under an innocuous 'vacation photos' folder tree to disguise classified content as personal photos. Minutes before archiving he ran Sysinternals SDelete (secure-wipe / anti-forensics); VeraCrypt was run repeatedly to encrypt the container. Exfiltration occurred through personal Dropbox (web session + ks2 keystore rewrite + desktop client) and via removable media, with an Apple USB device wired to a Dropbox autoplay handler. The host's Windows event logs are otherwise benign; the FTK Imager / MagnetRAMCapture / VankoLogical.E01 / StarkCollector activity in 2017-2018 is the examiner's lawful acquisition of the host and is NOT attributed to the suspect. All eight findings were independently judge-verified against the NTUSER.DAT supertimeline.

MITRE ATT&CK techniques: **T1078**, **T1039**, **T1560.001**, **T1074.001**, **T1564**, **T1070.004**, **T1567.002**, **T1052.001**

Findings: **8** total | **8** judge-confirmed.

## Findings

| # | Time (UTC)           | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Artifact : offset | ATT&CK    | Stage          | Conf. | Judge     |
|---|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------|----------------|-------|-----------|
| 1 | 2016-06-29T20:20:44Z | Insider used valid credentials to map the corporate research file server \\192.168.1.5\StarkResearch as drive Z: (HKCU\Network\Z + Map Network Drive MRU + MountPoints2 ##192.168.1.5#StarkResearch).                                                                                              | NTUSER.DAT : 6227 | T1078     | initial-access | high  | confirmed |
| 2 | 2016-06-29T20:19:00Z | Browsed the classified research share into 'Level 7/8 Classified', 'Biochemical' and 'Mutant Genome' directories and opened classified documents (ZF DNA splice test notes.docx, Rapid cell regeneration research.docx, Nina Lam mutation/sturgeon research) - BagMRU shell items + Word User MRU. | NTUSER.DAT : 6173 | T1039     | collection     | high  | confirmed |
| 3 | 2016-06-30T01:28:25Z | Archived the stolen research with 7-Zip - HKCU\SOFTWARE\7-Zip Compression ArchHistory (LZMA2, level 5) producing 'vacation photos.7z' (shell-item created 01:28:26); 'NinaResearch.zip' also created. 7-Zip (7z1602-x64.exe) had been installed from Downloads at 06/29 16:01.                     | NTUSER.DAT : 6279 | T1560.001 | collection     | high  | confirmed |
| 4 | 2016-06-30T02:06:18Z | Staged the archived classified data on removable drive D: under an innocuous 'vacation photos' folder tree (D:\vacation photos\vacation photos\Level 8 Classified\Mutant Genome; \Level 7 Classified\Biochemical) - HKCU TypedPaths.                                                               | NTUSER.DAT : 6318 | T1074.001 | collection     | high  | confirmed |

| # | Time (UTC)           | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Artifact : offset | ATT&CK    | Stage           | Conf.  | Judge     |
|---|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------|-----------------|--------|-----------|
| 5 | 2016-06-30T01:55:31Z | Concealed the exfiltrated material behind benign 'vacation photos' naming (folder tree + 'vacation photos.7z') to disguise classified content as personal photos - RecentDocs\7z + OpenSavePidlMRU\7z + TypedPaths.                                                                                                | NTUSER.DAT : 6300 | T1564     | defense-evasion | medium | confirmed |
| 6 | 2016-06-30T01:23:34Z | Ran Sysinternals SDelete (secure-delete / anti-forensics) minutes before archiving - HKCU\SOFTWARE\Sysinternals\SDelete EulaAccepted=1 (01:23:34); SDelete.zip present in RecentDocs. VeraCrypt 1.17 was also installed (06/29 16:03) and run x64, indicating encryption of the exfil container.                   | NTUSER.DAT : 6278 | T1070.004 | defense-evasion | medium | confirmed |
| 7 | 2016-06-30T01:44:14Z | Exfiltrated data to personal Dropbox cloud storage - IE DOMStorage dropbox.com/www.dropbox.com (01:44:14), Dropbox keystore HKCU\SOFTWARE\Dropbox\ks2 rewritten (01:47:14), Dropbox desktop client launched (07/07 01:43); TypedURLs include dropbox.com and icloud.com.                                           | NTUSER.DAT : 6288 | T1567.002 | exfiltration    | high   | confirmed |
| 8 | 2016-06-17T10:44:05Z | Used removable media as an exfiltration channel - archive staged to removable D: drive, and an Apple USB device (WpdDeviceHandler USB VID_05AC&PID_12A8) was configured with a Dropbox autoplay DropTarget handler - HKCU MountPoints2. (Corroborative: USB-autoplay config predates the 06/30 theft by ~12 days.) | NTUSER.DAT : 5872 | T1052.001 | exfiltration    | medium | confirmed |

## Kill-Chain Coverage

Stages with findings: **initial-access, defense-evasion, collection, exfiltration**

Not observed: reconnaissance, resource-development, execution, persistence, privilege-escalation, credential-access, discovery, lateral-movement, command-and-control, impact

## Evidence Coverage

**CyLR live-response (vanko-c-drive.CYLR)** — no analyzer applied

**Physical disk surface\_physical.E01 (BitLocker)** — no analyzer applied

■ gap: analyze\_disk\_filesystem (BitLocker-locked: 0 files scanned (no recovery key))

**NTUSER.DAT (PC User registry)** — analyzed by build\_supertimeline, search\_case\_artifact

**Prefetch (execution history)** — analyzed by build\_supertimeline

**Windows Event Logs (Security/System/Application)** — analyzed by parse\_event\_logs

**Amcache.hve** — no analyzer applied

■ gap: parse\_amcache (Dirty hive: AmcacheParser produced no CSV (needs transaction-log replay))

**\$MFT (filesystem metadata)** — no analyzer applied

■ gap: analyze\_disk\_filesystem (Standalone \$MFT not parseable by fls (needs MFTECmd))

## Evidence integrity

All evidence under the case directory was treated strictly read-only; analysis was performed exclusively through the typed sift-ir-agent MCP server. Each finding above cites the artifact and offset it derives from and carries an independent judge verdict. AI-assisted conclusions are labelled as such; deterministic tool output is preserved in the case audit trail. This report is generated from committed analysis artifacts and introduces no new claims.